Engraved Plate (Row 2473)

Encyclopaedia Britannica (1771)

Historical source

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Extracted Text

REBMITA, in ecology. See SCARASRUS.

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The onager, or wild aſs, has, by ſome authors, been confounded with the zebra; but very improperly, for this laſt is a diſtinct ſpecies; for the onager is not ſtreaked like this, nor is his ſhape ſo beautiful. Wild-aſſes are ſaid to be very ſwift of courſe; and when they ſee a man, they make a bound, and immediately fly away; inſomuch, that there is no taking of them, but by traps and gins. They have much the ſame ſhape as common aſſes; but they are of a brighter colour, and there runs a white liſt from the head to the tail. Of the hide of theſe aſſes, and particularly of that part next the rump, they make that excellent leather which we call ſhagreen, and which is put to ſo many curious uſes.

In America they have no aſſes at all, nor yet horſes; but they have been carried thither long ago, at firſt by the Spaniards, and afterwards by other nations, where they have multiplied greatly; inſomuch, that, in ſome places, there are whole droves of them that run wild, and are very hard to be caught. Aſſes in general carry the heavieſt burdens in proportion to their bulk; and, as their keeping coſts little or nothing, it is a great wonder they are not put to more uſes than they generally are among us.

The fleſh of the common aſs is never eaten in theſe parts of the world; though ſome pretend their colts are tender, and not diſagreeable. [Plate LXXV. fig. 2.]

3. The zebra.—This animal has the figure and graceſulneſs of the horſe, joined to the ſwiftneſs of the ſtag. He is about 7 feet long, from the point of the muzzle to the origin of the tail, and about 4 feet high The colour of his ſkin is beautiful and uniform, conſiſting of alternate parallel rings of black and white diſpoſed in the moſt regular manner, as repreſented in the plate. [LXXV. fig. 3.] He is generally leſs than the horſe, and larger than the aſs.

The Zebra is found no where but in the eaſtern and ſouthern provinces of Africa, from Æthiopia to the Cape of Good Hope, and from the Cape of Good Hope to Congo. The Dutch have been at great pains to tame and uſe them for domeſtic purpoſes, but with little ſucceſs. He is hard-mouthed, and kicks when any perſon attempts to touch or come near him. He is reſtleſs and obſtinate as a mule: but perhaps the wild horſe is naturally as untractable as the Zebra; for, it is probable, if he were early acculſtomed to obedience and a domeſtic life, he would become as docile as the horſe.

ERANARCHA, a public officer among the ancient Greeks, whoſe buſineſs was to preſide over and direct the alms and proviſions made for the poor. Cornelius Nepos, in his life of Epaminondas, deſcribes his office thus: when any perſon was reduced to poverty, taken captive, or had a daughter to marry, which he could not effect for want of money, &c. the eranarcha called an aſſembly of friends and neighbours, and taxed each according to his means and eſtate, to contribute towards his relief.

ERANTHEMUM, in botany, a genus of the diandria monogynia claſs. The calix is divided into five ſegments; the tube is filiform; and the ſtigma is ſimple. There is but one ſpecies, a native of Æthiopia.

ERASED, in heraldry. See ARRACHE.

ERECTION, in a general ſenſe, the act of raiſing or elevating any thing, as the erection of a perpendicular, &c. It is alſo uſed in a figurative ſenſe, as the erection of a biſhopric, marquiſate, &c.

ERECTOR CLITORIS. See CLITORIS.

ERECTOR PENIS. See PENIS.

EREMIT. See HERMIT.

EREMITA, in zoology. See SCARABÆUS.

ERFURT, a large and beautiful city of Upper Saxony in Germany, capital of Thuringia, and ſubject to the elector of Mentz: E. long. 11° 6′, N. lat. 51°.

ERGOT, in farriery, is a ſtub, like a piece of ſoft horn, about the bigneſs of a cheſnut, placed behind and below the paſtern-joint, and commonly hid under the tuſt of the fetlock.

ERICA, or HEATH, in botany, a genus of the octandria monogynia claſs. The calix conſiſts of four leaves, and the corolla of four ſegments; the filaments are inſerted into the receptacle; the antheræ are biſid; and the capſule has four cells. There are thirty-eight ſpecies, five of which are natives of Britain, *viz.* the vulgaris, or common heath; the cinerea, or fine-leaved heath; the tetralix, or croſs-leaved heath; the ciliaris, or rough-leaved heath; and the multiflora, or firleaved heath.

ERIDANUS, in aſtronomy. See Vol. I. p. 487.

ERIE, a vaſt lake to the weſtward of Penſilvania, in North America, ſituated between 80° and 87° W. long. and between 41° and 42° N lat.

ERIGERON, or SWEET FLEA BANE, in botany, a genus of the ſyngeneſia polygamia ſuperflua claſs. The receptacle is naked; the pappus is hairy; and the radii of the corolla are linear and very narrow. There are ſixteen ſpecies, two of which are natives of Britain, *viz.* the acre, or blue-flowered flea-bane; and the canadenſe, or Canada flea-bane.

ERINACEUS, or HEDGE-HOG, in zoology, a genus of quadrupeds belonging to the order of feræ, the characters of which are theſe: they have two foreteeth in the upper-jaw, at a conſiderable diſtance from one another, and two in the under jaw, leſs diſtant; and they have two recumbent dog-teeth, one on each ſide. There are three ſpecies, *viz.* 1. The europæus, or common hedge-hog, with round ears, and creſted noſtrils. It is about nine inches long; the upper part of the body is totally covered with ſharp prickles, and the under part is covered with hair. The hedge-hog, even when ſtanding on his legs, has a very ugly aſpect. His body is an oblong maſs, convex above, terminated on the fore-part by a very ſharp muzzle, and mounted on four ſhort legs, of which nothing appears but the feet, and the tail is not diſcernible. His ears are broad, round, and ſhort; and his eyes are ſmall and protuberant. The length of his body, from the point of the muzzle to the anus, is about nine inches.

The hedge-hog has a very uncommon method of defending himſelf from the attacks of other animals: being poſſeſſed of little ſtrength or agility, he does not attempt to fly from or aſſail his enemies; but erects his briſtles, and rolls himſelf up like a ball, expoſing no part

Figure 1: *
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